

EASIA 237 Pansori Unit 1.mp4

Hello everybody and welcome back. We're beginning a new module today. So this is the first unit in our module on pansori performance in Korea. The topic of today's lecture is an introduction to this form, as well as an introduction to the story that we're looking at, an example of a performance of for today's unit. So what I'll be covering today, since this is the beginning of a new module, I'll begin just by giving a quick overview of what we'll be doing for the next three units. And after that, I'll explain in a little bit more detail the sort of assigned resources, including reading and two short videos associated with this. unit So if you haven't had a chance to look through those assigned videos and reading yet, I recommend perhaps waiting till after I've introduced those resources and then stopping, going through the reading and the two videos, and then returning to this.

After that, I'll give a brief sort of reiteration of some of the main points made in one of those videos and raise some additional issues about the study. First off, studying performances in general, music and theatrical performance. Then I'll have a bit more to say about pansori as a theatrical form and then sort of return to some of those issues in the study of performance. to discuss how they relate to the study of this particular style of performance. After this, we'll move on to discussing our example for today: the story of Shim Chong. And what we'll be looking at is the sort of differences that exist, whether we're considering it as a piece of folklore, as a specific written text, a few excerpts of which you'll be reading as part of this unit, or as a pansori performance.

And so, just to note this, you know, slides 9 through 15 are quite long. The last three are just images, so that should go relatively quickly. Finally, to conclude, I'll just have a few additional thoughts on what it means to study a tradition. that is continuing to change as history goes on. So today we won't be talking in too much detail about the history of this form, but we will be talking a bit, sort of generally, about how we can study something that's so fluid, right? Something that's always changing across history. And then, as usual, I'll have a few points about the assignment and quiz associated with this unit. So, to think a bit more about what's going on in this module.

In the first unit, what we're doing today and the sort of associated assignments for today is all about the story of Simcheong and as an example of pansori performance in general. So the main goal of this unit is just to introduce you to this form. As we'll discuss later today, there's quite a few different examples of what we could have been told using this form. In fact, there's a lot of variety to this, something we'll be getting into throughout the But today, we're using just one example of a piece from this form to sort of some consistent aspects of it. Also, I'm not going to be talking too much about a kind of chronological history of this form, how it's changed from the past until the present.

You might imagine this is an important theme of this class, which presents a kind of interesting challenge, right? Because we need to decide if we want to introduce some general details, like which point in history we're going to focus on as the example of that. So in some ways, I think the best way to think of what we're doing is this unit is focused on pansori today, but it's a version of

this form that is meant to sort of represent the historical identity of this form across a very long period. We'll cover some issues with this when we move on to the second and third units of the module, but the basic goal is just to sort of introduce the form in general

sort of way of distinguishing this that I like to use is that we're kind of treating the entire history of pansori as one period not disregarding the changes and transformations that have taken place in this period but kind of trying to look at it as looking at what's consistent or looking at what are some kind of general shared features that we can identify. Often, especially in linguistic research, I'm kind of perhaps misusing the term a little bit here, but this is what we might call a synchronic study. That is, it's a study that's not necessarily focused on change over time; rather, looking at a sort of slice of history and treating it as more or less static. This doesn't mean disregarding the potential for change; it just means that this.

Kind of change and transformation is not really our focus; sort of scholarly term that's used in contrast to this might be what we could refer to as a diachronic study, which would be comparing two different periods and thinking about how we got from period A to period B. This is a very simplified definition of those two terms, but this is one way of kind of distinguishing two forms of scholarship, right? So, at least in this first unit, I'll be mentioning some historical context, but we're not going to be very meticulously concerned with differences at different points in history. This will be the topic of units two and three. So in the second unit we'll be covering this sort of discussion or debate about where this form actually comes from, including a little bit of discussion of some other cultural practices that are thought to have a really close relationship to the early phases of Hansori history.

And then what we can talk about in a lot more detail, with a lot more sort of concrete sources to reference, is to think about how really moving into the 19th and early 20th century, how this sort of form of performance kind of reached what is largely thought to be its peak, right? What we might think of as the kind of heyday or sort of golden era of Hansori performance, how the tradition has continued despite some pretty major changes or different ways of thinking about the role of this kind of performance in culture and society. So basically, we'll cover like three phases or three stages of the early history of this form, beginning in a very sort of interesting topic for scholars, but one that's challenging to say a whole lot of concrete, universally agreed-upon ideas about its very origins, to this kind of 19th-century era of great mainstream popularity, towards moving closer to the present period of what we might think of as reform, modernization, and to use one.

of the kind of key terms associated with this class, this idea of heritagization, right? So what does it mean once a kind of national society decides that something is culturally significant, culturally important, and devotes resources and kind of state institutions to defining and maintaining and promoting, and kind of preserving this form of. That's sort of where we'll leave off in unit two, which will prepare us for unit three, during which we'll think about Hansori today in terms of, you know, the kind of contemporary status of this form, looking at some different attitudes that are expressed in relation to what role this form should play in society and looking at some really creative kind of, perhaps deliberately provocative in some ways, example of how the form can really be used as a way to express really contemporary ideas to sort of fit it into a kind of

contemporary pop cultural landscape.

So in this case, we'll be sort of continuing a theme that's going to develop over the course of the next three units, which is, you know, what does it mean to consider Hansori as a kind of single art form with a sort of set of shared characteristics and ideas and sort of performance styles that are going to happen across the entire field versus as a collection of kind of unique styles and lineages. And this is something I'll also be talking about quite a bit today. We're talking about an art form that's practiced by individual performers who are parts of their own.

So this is the kind of backdrop that's going to exist across all three of the in the third unit. The sort of additional kind of wrinkle or complication to this dynamic going to be, you know, thinking about this art form from a 21st century perspective. This kind of contrasts what we might say is sort of between authenticity and creativity, preservation versus innovation; something that's meant to be kind of maintained and preserved as it is or something that could be allowed to sort of change and adapt according to the time. Something that might sort of reimagine itself in relationship to contemporary culture. So this, in some ways, can be thought of as a. We might imagine some sort of strong opinions on either side of this.

But it can also be seen as something that, you know, the same performer might be able to kind of imagine the importance of both of these things at once. So it's not necessarily about conflict; just sort of a few possible roles that the form can play in contemporary society. So, in addition to that overview of the different topics, we'll be discussing throughout this module. Here are a few kinds of general guiding questions we can use to connect the stuff we'll be covering in this module to the broader themes of the class and hopefully to some other things we might encounter in arts and cultures of other times and places. So, the first one of these is really a sort of methodological question. That is, what does it mean to study a performing art, right?

As opposed to studying something we might imagine to be a bit more static, like, or even cinema. You know, everyone who watches a film presumably gets more or less the same version of it depending on, you know, as long as we're watching the same cut or something like this, no matter what theatre it's screening in, you're watching the same thing. Performing arts, of course, there's going to be some unique elements in every single performer, right? So this introduces some challenges and opportunities, let's say, for academic study of these forms. And one of these is that this is something that's always changing. This is true of other cultural forms as well. It's true of all, I would imagine, theatrical styles. This is something that we can describe as being kind of fluid, right?

This isn't a fixed tradition that has always been done exactly the same way from its earliest expression to the present day. It's something that changes in relation to the, you know, interest of individual performers and audiences, and also in response to kind of broader cultural patterns, which introduces its own challenges. One of these really interesting aspects is thinking about the role the audience plays in shaping the present and future of a particular performance style. In the case of pansori, we can think of this in a lot of different ways in that in certain styles of performance, at least, audience participation, sort of comments and expressions made by members of the

audience, is a really. crucial and important part of the performance itself. So we can kind of play with this idea of the role of the audience, right?

We can take it quite literally in the case of some pansori performances, but we can also think more generally about how the kind of interests and sort of trends, or like things that come in and out of style among different audiences, might also kind of guide the future of the style in different directions. I'm thinking in a different direction, a different sort of focus here. This question I'm phrasing it very deliberately, right? I think it's when we're talking about a very old and traditional form, it's always interesting to think about where these things come from. But when we're also talking about a form with a very long history, we go back to the very early phases of that form. It's very hard to say anything too concrete about those earliest expressions of it, right?

And especially in light of something that's undergone such, has had such highs and lows and such interesting transformations over the course of its modern and contemporary history. We might sort of question if understanding the earliest possible date we can put on anything that we can label as pansori, how important is this relate to understanding the form as it. exists. So, I'm not going to answer this question now, but I think it's something worth keeping in mind, especially as we move into unit two. Somewhat related, there's this ongoing question about sort of tension, perhaps, between authenticity and innovation, thinking mainly about how these phenomena exist in the present, right? What is it that we want forms like this to do?

Do we expect them to give us a kind of time travel experience to know exactly what it would have been like to witness one of these performances 100, 200 years ago? Or do we want to go to the theater to experience something that's going to really directly connect? with things as we experience them today. And as I mentioned in an earlier part of this lecture, we can think of this as a debate in which there's, you know, conflict between opposing opinions and opposing sides of an. But we can also think of this as a, you know, an opportunity for performers and scholars just to think about these as two two ends of a spectrum, perhaps, in which we're always trying to our own way through, right?

That is neither 100 percent authentic versus 100 percent creative, but thinking of both of these things as sort of mutual in importance. And then we need to figure out, well, OK, how can I do that? How can I combine those. two things in my own performance if we're thinking of ourselves as one of these practitioners. So, to move on to our actual resources for this first unit, most of the resources are from one specific example that is the story of Simcheong. I just want to provide a brief note on Romanization, right, the sort of spelling of from Korean using the Roman alphabet. This might appear somewhat chaotic, but basically everything you see that looks kind of like this, these are all just different ways of spelling the same two words.

And this is the name of the main character of this story that we'll be focusing on today. So, the reason why my presentation is somewhat chaotic in terms of what I'm using is that different sources that we're looking at use different spellings, right? They use different Romanization systems, and I'm trying to use the system that's used in whichever resource we're talking about. But in any case, I'm referring to the same character and therefore, like the same basic story. I know

it's somewhat confusing, but I think that's the best way to approach the kind of variety of sources that we'll be looking at in this unit. So, the first of these is a. This is an excerpt from a translation of the story of Simcheong, and as I'm sure you've noticed, if you've looked.

at it already it's very heavily annotated, right? There's lots of footnotes, and I've included those footnotes for the excerpts that we're looking at case you're curious to learn more about the sort of references that are made to various other kinds of literary and historical things throughout this text. So this appears in a book-length study of the history of this form. It's sort of like an appendix to the scholar's work looking at pansori in general, from its earliest phases up until later history. We'll be reading another excerpt from this book in the next unit about that early phase of history. But the part of it that's assigned today is just an English language translation of what you might think of as a although there's some problems with that term.

Basically, this is a kind of excerpt of a full translation of the story from the early 20th century that has a kind of complicated history of its own that I'll share a little bit with you about in a few minutes. But I'm assigning it just so you can get a of what the story is about and how it's kind of in a sort of written form of one style of pansori performance, which you know, a complication that I'll get into in a few minutes. The two videos that we have are hosted by the Korean Cultural Center of Los Angeles, I believe they're kind of produced by some South Korean institutions: the Ministry of Culture, Sports and Tourism, and Arts Council Korea.

So these are part of an introductory series on different styles of Korean traditional music, and they have really well-produced English subtitles and some English narration, which is why I've chosen these videos for us to use. So the first of them is a general introduction to the form. This goes over the most important details just about what pansori is, what are the kind of consistent elements of this form. I will be referring to some of these details, but I encourage you to watch the video to get a direct from an authoritative source, and then I'll kind of give us some perspective on some of those details. I'll reiterate some of them, but not all of them, right? So make sure you do watch the video to get a good sense of the form.

And then the second of them is an excerpt from the performance, or let's say from one performance of the story that's performed by a kind of interesting example of both a performer and a scholar, and I'll talk a little bit more about those two roles as we go on. So this is another great example of, you know, the complexity of performing and studying these things in contemporary times. A lot of people who study this form professionally also have at least some training as a performer. But setting all of that aside for now, what we're looking at is a kind of climactic scene from the performance, particularly dramatic and famous, one that has a parallel in the translated excerpt that we'll be reading to accompany this. So, as I mentioned, I recommend that you go through all of these resources before you watch the rest of the lecture, and this is especially true of video number one. Video number two, you may want to revisit when you get to the point in the lecture; we'll all discuss it, the excerpt of the text I recommend. Reading carefully once and perhaps returning to appreciate in excerpts or like reread some portions of it either in the middle or at the end of the video.

So I hope everybody's had a chance to go through that reading in two videos, and now we can jump into some other ideas about studying performance in general and specifically about studying pansori. So, as I mentioned, there are some kind of different things to consider when we study any kind of performance versus other forms that we might perceive of as being a bit more static. One approach might be just to treat it more or less the same way as we would treat a piece of literature. right To focus on the words, to focus on the literary expression that's kind of evident in what we might think of as the script or something like this for the form that we're reading right. There's lots we can do here.

Often, scripts of plays or operas or other performances have a lot of literary complexity. We could, you know, study some rhythmic or linguistic patterns even in the written form alone. We can, of course, do some analysis of the plot, the themes of the story, the sophistication of the allusions, and so on right. Basically, all of the tools of literary studies are appropriate to use when studying, you know, any kind of performance tradition that has like a linguistic or oral component. If we treat it as music, though, if we're thinking of a performance that's accompanied by music or involves singing or involves, you know, an orchestral instrument, something like this, of course, then at this point, the script itself is not necessarily the most important thing, right?

We might approach this from a purely, like, musicological perspective and just think about understanding the complexity of patterns of rhythms and melodies, all of these things that exist as, you know, different aspects of technical musical performance. These can be studied in their own. Right, they can also be studied almost as a form of narrative, to put it really simply. Right, we can think about how these musical aspects might interact with the meaning that we get from the written part of the performance. Right, and so you know maybe a musicologist might be more focused on those kind of technical musical aspects of it. A literary scholar might be more interested in the words that go along with this performance, but I would imagine scholars in both of those fields might agree that you can't look at one without paying attention to the other.

Right, this is the sort of brilliant thing about performances that involve. both music and dialogue or narration or something like this. They sort of work together to create the meaning that we get from the performance. Another approach to this that might be thinking about both the music and the text in a slightly different way, really to think about the sort of physical skill and training that's required to make to sort of perform the acts that exist within that performance, right? We might think about how those talents are necessary, or rather how they're developed, right? Where do they come from? How are people trained? How might we think of the sort of physical actions that the performer takes in. order to produce both the words and the music that we see in the performance.

Another, perhaps more easily overlooked element of this, especially when we're getting into extremely technically complex forms like pansori, we might also think about, you know, how does the audience also cultivate a kind of talent, right? Those of us who have very little experience watching and listening to these kinds of performances are not going to notice the same thing that an audience that is really, let's say, well trained, right? Someone who really knows what to look for, they really appreciate these minor technical distinctions that can. be made by different performers

in different contexts, and so on. This is also something that can be cultivated, right? And we might think about where those talents of appreciation come from.

I'm going to use the word connoisseurship to talk about this, basically just referring to this idea that an audience also has different degrees of preparation for what they're seeing. And those that we might put on the kind of high-end, real sort of expert audience members we could call, you know, connoisseurs, this kind of thing. Those who really understand the details of what they're experiencing. On the other hand, we might think of this from a slightly different perspective and consider the performance as something that's a part of social and cultural history. That is, we might think of the sort of individual performers; they have their own lineages. These can be studied the history of teachers and students over the history of the form.

Audiences also have a history; we can think of this both in a kind of small context like individual groups of people. We can think about it in general, sort of what is the demographic that is interested in observing this kind of form. And then, of course, think about these issues in relation to other things that are going on at the same point in history. So we might think of a few different disciplines who would be primarily interested in this perspective on studying a. Of course, historians looking at distant or more recent history, anthropologists who might do what we call ethnographic research, finding themselves among a group of either pansori or other performance style audiences or performers, and thinking about the dynamics that exist within that community.

Or ethnomusicology, specifically focused on music as a part of culture, and so on. So there are other perspectives that we can take; they might not have the same interest in the technical or literary details of the scripts, but would be more interested in the social, communal, and historical status of various performing arts traditions. So all of this I would say applies to any different style of performance, whether we're talking about other performance styles in East Asia, other places of the world, or other points in history. We can think of these dynamics as being relevant to all of those different potential topics. But now, let's talk a little bit more about pansori itself. This is going to recap some of the details from the video that we have hopefully already watched fairly carefully.

It's very short and quite engaging, so I hope we enjoyed that. But basically, the kind of traditional form of this performance is that we really have two people on the stage. We have the singer who is responsible for performing all roles and narration. So you might think of it as a kind of storyteller-like role in which one person kind of takes on multiple different characters, and they also provide the narration, right? This kind of sort of third-person description of what else is going on in the story at the same time. They alternate between singing and a kind of, you know, elevated style of speaking— a sort of recitation style. And typically, we hear the singing occurs during dialogue; that is when the singer is embodying one of the characters and speaking in their voice.

And they use narration, or rather speaking, kind of recitation when they're providing the narration, right? Providing that kind of third-person description of what's going on. Then the second person on the stage, we could call the drummer, right? They have the instrument; they're playing this kind of upright drum. They provide rhythm to accompany the vocal performance, but as they note in the video, the drummer also speaks occasionally, right? They'll provide these sort of vocal

interjections to kind of interact. with and engage with the singer at certain points in the performance. Now, a third major component of these performances is the audience, something that I believe is maybe alluded to in the video but not discussed in a lot of detail. In many contexts in which Pansori is performed, the audience is also kind of expected to participate.

There are sort of comments that they can shout out from the audience. It's not considered rude. It can be considered, you know, there is a right and a wrong way to do it, let's say, right, that you'll want to say the right kinds of things at the right moments to express your appreciation of what's going on on the stage to kind of encourage the performer and to create that kind of like interactive dynamic between the audience and the performer. Another kind of characteristic element of this style of performance is what we can call like a limited amount of set dressing. The singer will often have a fan that they'll use as a kind of multi-purpose prop to, you know, to accompany their gestures, to kind of open and close at particular moments, and to use to sort of stand in for like various other objects that the characters might be interacting with at different points in the story.

And then the only kind of set dressing that you'll often see in these performances is a kind of painted or decorated screen in the background. It might be, you know, thematically related to what's going on in the story, but it might just be another sort of like aesthetically appropriate like decoration to have in the backdrop of the stage. So we don't see in at least kind of, you know, traditional or like standard versions of the performance. We don't see a lot of really detailed backdrops or like multiple props or, you know, costume changes or anything like this that we might see in other performance styles. Now, a kind of fascinating thing about this style of performance is that like a full-length performance that is like an entire story from beginning, middle to end might last up to eight hours.

Of course, they might do this in stages with an intermission, with a break in between. They might be a bit shorter, let's say five to eight hours. But another thing that we'll see, and by the way, this is also true of a lot of, like you know, other traditional theatre styles that can go quite long, if we wanted to witness a full performance. We might also see them performed in segments, as appropriate to, you know, the attention span and endurance of an audience or things like that. So it's very conventional and normal to have a singer rather than perform, or rather like a pair of singer and drummer rather than just perform a single story from beginning to end, which can take quite a long time.

A full performance, you know, it might last a couple hours, and they might do a kind of what we might call like a medley of excerpts from different stories, right? Or maybe even like a single sequence of scenes from the same story that would last a couple of hours or something like this, right? So there's a lot of variety in terms of how long an actual performance can last. But if someone was doing like a full production of a single full story, they can be quite long. So that's the form itself. Let's think about a few more details, going a bit deeper into how the style is transmitted from teacher to student, what kinds of stories exist within this tradition, and the kind of different potentials for variation that exist within the form.

So one thing we can point out now that we'll go into a lot more detail about the second and third

unit of this module is that at one point in it's thought that there were like 12 full pieces, right? So when I talk about five to eight hour performances, what I'm referring to is here labeled as like a full piece, right? Like a narrative from beginning, middle, and end that might be quite long. Of those 12, I have a question mark here because there's some debate about the exact number of these. Five of these very old pieces, we can call them, remain as this kind of official corpus of Pansori text. I'll say a bit more about that in a but basically there are five like major narratives that, when we see very kind of traditional performances, they tend to draw from those five stories.

But again, there's lots of variety here in terms of the scenes or the different parts that they can excerpt from those performances. So it's not like there's only five shows possible, right? There's still a very great range of possibilities for what you might see in one of these performances. These five, sort of like mainstream corpus, these five stories, some of them are adapted from folklore, as is the case with the example we'll be looking at today. Others are drawn from both Korean and Chinese history and literature, and so on. So, they come from a variety of, but they have kind of origins in much older storytelling and historical traditions. But even within this really limited group, there's kind of limitless potential for variation in performance.

So, one way to think about this is in terms of like groups of performers, both in the present and in history right. We can call these schools not necessarily in reference to, like, a center of education, but school in the sense of a school of thought right. This is a conceptual group of people that exists within a lineage of instruction, but it might go back very far. So, a kind of multi-generational tradition that's taught differently to different people. So, a complex way of saying there are like several different schools of pansori performance that might have both subtle and major differences in which pieces they tend to perform more often, how they stage those pieces, how they're sung, even variations in the script gesture. performance right.

Some of these distinctions can be made on the basis of school. These kinds of big groups of performers. So the variation again is going to be in terms of like which parts of these pieces they emphasize, which scenes, which songs are performed, and even the manner in which they're performed. And here's a good time to talk a little bit about how one becomes a performer. This is a, you know, to put it lightly, a very complex and intensive process that involves years of dedicated study with like a single teacher, right? You're sort of the student or disciple of someone that's going to transmit their method to you. This also involves sort of traditionally meant to involve like a period during which you're going off on your own just practicing, just developing the kind of endurance and vocal skill necessary to produce all of the sounds and emotions required for the style of performance.

So it's not easy to do, to put it lightly, right? And we'll have a bit more to say about this training process in later units of the class. But we might also think then in terms of you know, we can sort of categorize schools in these like big, like group-based distinctions in style. But we might also think of the differences that exist among individual performers. Right. Even students in the same school, even you know the same generation of students of the same teacher, both just because humans are unique individuals and also because there's a kind of artistic interest in defining your own unique talents and sort of presenting something that audiences aren't going to get from anywhere

else. There's also just a lot of variation among individuals.

So even within the same school, it's not like the school is just constantly producing, you know, carbon copies of the same performer that's going to do everything in the exact same way, no matter what's going on. So there's a lot of opportunity. For individuals, like innovation and creativity, or even just on different styles, different approaches to singing pieces from the same stories, we might also think about how, you know, the same teacher might sort of recognize different potential, or different talents, or different needs among all of their students, and kind of treat all of their students slightly differently, right? This is a highly individualized process. That doesn't mean that a teacher can't have more than one student, but it does mean that that transmission process is gonna go slightly differently depending on the individuals that are working together.

right I think this is true in a lot of cases but it's something that I think becomes particularly interesting to pay attention to when we're studying a form like Pansori that does have so many conventions or things that feel like rules right. There still might not be visible to those who aren't like practiced connoisseurs. There's still a lot of opportunity for individual kind of unique differences in performance style from singer to And then even setting aside differences in individual performers, another really fascinating aspect of studying performance is that every single performance right. Every time this performer goes on stage to put on a. There are going to be slight differences. Some of these can be controlled; some of them are kind of, but all of them mean that each time you go to see a, you're gonna be getting something slightly different, right?

This is a kind of exciting thing about live theatrical performance, right? Sometimes just the atmosphere of the theater might be different. The mood and health of the performer might be in a different condition. The audience members, especially in a form that involves audience interaction, things might play out slightly differently on that basis. Now I'm talking, you know, all of these. sort of potential for variation that exists even when we're talking about different sorts of performances based on these same five major stories. Another important thing not to overlook is it's really not the case that pansori only means any performance from these five pieces, right? Throughout the history of the performance, there are new pieces being produced, and this is something that continues even into the present.

But here we get into this question about, you know, what is the kind of authentic protected heritage version of this tradition versus other ways of understanding it and maybe sort of pushing the boundaries. of what it means. And sort of thinking of ways that it can be changed or updated to accommodate contemporary times. And so, of course, this is something we'll be jumping into in the third unit of this module. So let's think back to those four big categories involved with the study of performance and think about what it might mean in relation to the study of pansori. We talked about study as literature, as music, as a set of techniques, and as a social and cultural history.

So, of course, as with other theatrical forms, the scripts, the texts of these performances are incredibly deep and sort of worthy of this kind of intense, like, close. reading academic study I'm sure you noticed with the excerpt that you read for today there's lots of allusions. There's lots of

references to cultural and historical details, some humor. There's some sort of variation in what we might call register, right? Sometimes it sounds very formal; it sounds very informal, potentially kind of vulgar in some cases, things like this. We could analyze the structure. We could analyze how different characters are written, you know, the style of speech that they use, dialect, and so on. To say there's a lot of rich material for study here. But the issue is that this is, as I've said, it's a fluid.

form in which individual performances might actually have some really major differences in the text that they're reciting, right. So it's not the case that everybody is performing the exact same script, let's call it. A lot of these variations, whether we're talking about school teacher individual, there's lots of different opportunities for kind of editing of what to emphasize, what to cut, what to include, and so on. Now, if we're thinking about it as music, as is the case of treating this literarily, right? This is a very complex musical form. There are lots of different, you know, rhythms and melodies that are used in a single performance. These are kind of correlated with different emotional states that the performer is attempting to. These are also cases where we might see different preferences or different sort of lineages, right?

So we could perhaps devote a full study just to say, you know, how does this one singer perform this particular piece in relation to others? One kind of question that comes up here is, you know, what sort of format do we use to label, classify, and like annotate these musical features? Might find in some cases it's really, you know, helpful to use kind of musicological terms. That is, you know, a terminology for the description of music that is developed outside of the context of hansuri performance. In other cases, some scholars might find there isn't really like a close enough match in that sort of standard set of terms, in which case it's necessary to introduce some like specialized vocabulary that's used only within the context of like hansuri performance and like audience appreciation.

This kind of brings us to the discussion of technique, right? A lot of these technical features, both the sort of subtle differences in like rhythmic pattern or what we call mode in musical terms, things like this, they're not immediately perceivable to just like any audience, right? Like I certainly am no expert in this performance style. We rely on the work of those who are to understand these things better. This kind of ability to discern almost requires its own training, right? Whether you're being trained as an audience member, or if you're actually taking the time to personally experience this rigorous training process in order to understand it. The kind of techniques, right, are something that almost has to be experienced in order to have a full understanding of.

So this is especially true of a form like hansuri that involves such a like unique and complex vocal style, right. And if you've watched the video, I'm sure you have a sense of what this is. I think certainly audience members can appreciate it. But if we wanted to write like a very detailed academic study about what exactly is going on in the voice when this happens, this is something that, you know, even if you understand what you're hearing, it might be difficult to understand just physically what's required to produce those sounds. So this also kind of leads into this question of social and cultural history, right? We might imagine that someone who has the opportunity to study the technique and kind of the technical aspects of this form.

as a performer to really be able to master those complex vocal techniques would also be able to give us a really precise and unique window into the history of, you know, the lineage and the school that they're a part of. And they would also probably have a very unique and like deep perspective on the kind of community of performers, even outside of their own school. So this is a very valuable perspective to have. It's also valuable to be able to kind of put those different schools and lineages into context with one another and also to think about a kind of broader view of history, right? If we're thinking about Pansori, 100 years ago, of course, training within a lineage is going to be very helpful for this.

But there's also lots of historical documents, lots of resources, and lots of other primary sources to draw on, especially to get like a deeper, longer-term history of that form. So, an interesting thing that I've mentioned already and want to reiterate here is that a lot of the scholars whose work we're going to be reading, and in fact whose performances we have watched, they have a kind of dual role as performers and scholars, right? So, they might be trained with like a traditional style by an older pansori performer, and then they might also concurrently be doing like academic training in fields of anthropology or ethnomusicology or something like this. In some cases, they may begin as performers and then go into universities to study the history of this performance style in more detail.

In other cases, they might be people who begin as scholars and then realize, I really need to learn how to do this myself in order to write a really good study of the form, right? So you'll see it's fairly common for scholars in this field to have this kind of dual identity as academic and practitioner. So those kind of general conceptual issues about the study of this form aside, let's think about the specific example that we are looking at in this unit. So like I said, a lot of the pansori pieces are inspired by folktales. That is, these are stories that predate their existence as pansori scripts that are then kind of adapted into this particular theatrical style, and they may also be adapted into countless other media as well.

But basically, the sort of versions of this different story are going to share the same components, right? The beginning is a man who's blind, and his wife gives birth to this kind of beautiful, talented daughter named Simcheong. But sadly, shortly after this, in addition to the father not being able to see her mother dies very soon after she's. And so, the kind of initial elements of the story involve the struggles that her father undergoes in order to raise this daughter. One of the first kind of pivotal moments in the story is when Simcheong offers to sacrifice herself to the sea, basically so that her father can regain his sight. This is a kind of complex; there's a lot of kind of complex plot that comes into the story here.

Basically, the father learns that if he is able to make a large donation of, I think, like 300 bags of rice to a particular temple, then he'll be sort of rewarded with the restoration of his sight. So, in order to acquire what he needs to make this donation, the daughter Simcheong allows herself to be sacrificed to kind of calm this unruly sea, sort of does so on behalf of sailors or fishermen. I'm sorry, I'm forgetting the exact identity of these people who are then going to give her father the required amount of rice. So, there's this kind of complex transaction of ritual and repayment going on in the story, the ultimate goal of which is to allow the father to regain his sight, the consequence being

losing Simcheong to the sea.

So, she offers to make this very profound sacrifice on behalf of her. Initially, it's unsuccessful, right? The father's sight is not restored. But what happens when Simcheong goes into the water is that she kind of arrives at this undersea palace where this god of the sea, god of the waters, lives who takes pity on her and allows her to be reborn famously in the lotus flower to live out her life. In that way, despite having undergone this great sacrifice. So after she is reborn in the lotus flower, she meets a king and they have this kind of long courtship and then he marries her. And then eventually the father and daughter are reunited. You know, up until now, the father has thought that she has been lost.

When they're reunited, the strength of their bond, the strength of their love for one another, restores his vision to make a kind of complex story short. And so, this is the kind of conclusion of the story during which his vision is restored. So, even in this very brief outline, I think you can start to see how there are different scenes, even within the folklore folktale version of this. If we're thinking about this as theatrical performers, as people putting on a show, you can already start to see the different acts or scenes of the story that might be either excerpted out of context and performed on their own. They might be stretched out to very long detail; part of what allows the performance to go on for five to eight hours; how they might be embellished.

So, this is just a kind of structure or on which artists and different creators can do all kinds of elaboration and editing. So, we might imagine the same basic frame to be a sort of essential core element of the story. Well, how does this story take written form? How is it performed on stage? We have lots of different sources to draw on. So, thinking about the excerpts that we have for today, this is part of a kind of genre of that's often called like pansori novels. We'll get into the sort of history of this form a little bit next week. But basically, we can think of this as kind of like written forms of pansori performances.

So we can use the word script, but it's also like a little bit misleading in one sense because we now know that the performances were going on before they were like widely available in written form. So it's not the case that anybody who wanted to stage a performance of the story of Sim Chong would have had to seek out like a written form of the script. This might be something transmitted orally within a kind of lineage of instruction long before any like concrete material evidence of the script itself is available. When these start becoming like widely available in sort of published form like for commercial audiences for like readers of these we're talking like late 19th early 20th century. So here's the kind of tricky aspect of this, right?

Rather than thinking of the script as the source from which the performance is adapted, it's a kind of reversed relationship. In fact, the written form is a kind of adapted version of some performance style that was going on before the existence of the written script. So you might think of it as a kind of a performance rather than a script that becomes the basis for a later performance. Another kind of curious thing about this is, of course. these are published and kind of marketed to readers, right? So this is something that you could buy and read and appreciate on its own even if you don't intend to like use it as the basis for your own performance, right?

So this is something that you read in the same way that you might read a novel, but in its written form, it kind of contains details that would tell you like what the performance would be like, allowing you to kind of imagine in your mind how that performance would play out. So this is what I mean by simulates elements of the performance. And I'll say a bit more about how it does that in a few minutes. So because this is a written document it has its own history, right? It's something that might be printed in various editions. It might originate, again, it might originate as a performance. It might be transcribed by hand as a That manuscript might then be used as the basis for a printed edition.

Just talking about textual history alone, right? We might imagine, or not imagine, we know there to be over 100 written versions of the pansori version of this story. So, this is setting aside all other folklore adaptations of the story of Simcheong, in general, talking just about those that represent in some way the pansori style presentation of the story. We have more than 100 to contend with. These come from about a dozen early printed versions that derive from like 60 manuscripts. Some of them might be different handwritten copies of the same performance. So, these are put together between 1870 and 1920. So, if you want to see how do we go from these dozen early printed versions to the 100 plus written versions, many of them might just be like new editions of some of these older printed versions.

Others might be transcriptions of later performances with no like textual history connection to the version that we're reading today. So all of this is to say, you know, here is one example. It's far from the only example. And it's one that kind of comes from a particular moment in history. And in our case, what we're looking at is an edition that was printed in 1916 in Jeonju, key city for pansori performance. And again, the sort of regional history of this form we'll talk about in future units. But basically, this is a transcription, right? That's based on the performance tradition of what we'll call the River and Mountain School. So, one of these particular groups of performers that have their own particular approach to the performance. The text that we have emerges from that school.

So it's not super important that we know this because I'm not expecting you to, oh because it's river and mountain school. Then A, B, and C are true about it. Just to give you the understanding that this is just one of hundreds of possible interpretations and adaptations of this story into Pansori form. But what else can we say about this text? Like, as we read it, what details can we pay attention to? Well, for one thing, I'd like to point out that this translation in full form is 110 pages long. I briefly considered asking you to read the entire thing, and then I decided, no, let's just look at the first and the last scenes, and then to kind of fill in the I provided that summary.

of you know the general folklore kind of structure of the story to help us understand the context. You'll also hopefully notice that there's some review in the final scene, right? We sort of recap what we've seen so far, the last phase of the story. So, as I mentioned, the plot itself can be retold in a few minutes. The story has its complexities, but it's, you know, a few different scenes, a few different sort of phases. The basic version of this can be told over the course of a few minutes. So, it's worth thinking about you; why is this version 110 pages long? Like, what exactly is added in this interpretation of the story? And how can we connect these sorts of unique features to both

performed and written elements of the story.

So, of course, you know, owing to the kind of context of this, as a pansori performance, we have this kind of alternation between dialogue that is words spoken in the words of the characters. They may be speaking to one another, in which case our imagined singer would be performing, you know, two roles in succession, going back and forth in dialogue. They might be providing a longer monologue, right? A sort of character speaking in their own voice, explaining what they're feeling, explaining what they're doing as the play goes on. And then we also have narration right This kind of third person description of other things that are happening within the story. So this alone accounts for, you know, most of what we see in the script, right?

We can say just the simple necessity of making this a pansori performance means it needs to be expressed in dialogue, monologue, and rather than just pure narration. As my, like, very, you know, amateurish summary of the plot unfolded, we think about this in the context of performance. What this allows the performer to do is to demonstrate their ability to embody these multiple characters, right? To make you feel as though you're listening to a different. person, when you watch the performance on the stage, and of course we might note the way that the script sort of encourages or lends itself to different styles of performance depending on who's speaking to kind of help the audience distinguish, okay, who is it that's talking now? Because these are all going to be performed by the same singer.

Another perhaps more subtle embellishment we might see in a script like this are a lot of what I would call patterned lists, right? If someone's doing something, they'll talk about everything that they're doing, right? If they're talking about a, they'll talk about many different aspects. of that garment. There's this kind of rhythmic flow of information that we see really often in these monologues and songs that are really just kind of patterned lists of different activities or objects, and so on. If the existence of these things is somewhat puzzling to you, if you're encountering it just as a text, I encourage you to think of this as another opportunity for the performer display some vocal flourishes. There are rhyme and rhythmic patterns that are kind of lost in translation that maybe we can see in the video version of the performance.

And all of these are not just filler, right? These are opportunities for us. to appreciate the talents of the performers even more. And so, these sort of long lists of objects or activities, they may not tell us a to appreciate the performance. And so, we might expect not to see these in adaptations of the same story in other media. Another thing that is a really prominent element of this particular version are a lot of what we call allusions, right? These are references to elements of classical Chinese history, of Korean history, of terms and phrases from literature and philosophy. This very deep kind of erudite way of speaking that's sort of peppered with all of these different references to different.

sources, hence necessitating the sort of large volume of footnotes in the back of our translation to explain exactly what all of these things mean. I think this is maybe our first opportunity to consider who is the intended audience for either the performance that this text is based on or even just for those who would be reading the text in the privacy of their own homes for entertainment or leisure

or something like this. We might imagine an older edition of this text would not have the same volume of footnotes that our contemporary translation has, which might cause us to assume that this is a version of the story that's not meant to educate or to entertain young children. Perhaps it's not meant exclusively to give us this kind of message of filial devotion and love between father and daughter.

That's the kind of core emotional dynamic of the story. It does that, but on top of it, it also gives us this really rich field of references that educated, learned audience members can appreciate and sort might fall on flat ears to those that don't have that kind of prior preparation to appreciate the story. The reason I'm spending so much time talking about this is that I think when we mention something adapted from folklore, perhaps our instinct is to assume that the intended audience is kind of like young children or something like this. Certainly, some adaptations of the story might have that in mind. When we see this level of complexity of allusions and sort of references to obscure topics, we might begin to say, oh, okay, maybe this is not that kind of folktale.

This is a folktale that might be targeted at a slightly more sophisticated or older audience. So that brings us to the kind of different layers of annotation that we see in this story. I pointed out those footnotes, all of those kind of numbered references where you have to turn to the back to read them. These are really added by the translator. This is the translator as a sort of scholar of literature, culture, and history attempting to explain all of the allusions and references and other details that this script is really full of. Not a page goes by without some kind of reference to some element of literature, history, or—there's another form of annotation that we also see on the page.

If you look on the kind of right side of the page, there's some italicized comments every now and then. These are what we call margin notes; the sides of the paper we call the margins. These are, let's say, translated or transcribed perhaps, because they're actually not translated. These are like Korean language terms that appear in the original text that the translator has chosen to include in their translation as well. They are really part of what I was saying earlier about how this transcription kind of simulates the performance. We're not going to go into too much detail about technical terminology for pansori performance, but basically, the clearest distinction that's made in those margin notes is whether the text is meant to be read as narration that is kind of spoken versus when it's meant to be sung in one of a great variety of modes or rhythmic patterns.

All of this term *aniri* refers to that narration. *Jongmori*, all of the other terms are references to different styles of singing, different sort of modes or rhythmic patterns that both the drummer and the singer would, in coordination with one another, kind of move into as they performed that part of the song. So, a sophisticated reader who knew what these terms meant would be able to create a more sort of vivid and accurate, let's say, kind of simulated version of their performance that's in their mind as they're reading through it.

So, this is what we can do with text alone, right? But, of course, especially if we've never seen Pansori performance. before it's helpful for us to have an actual video of a performance to look at, to see what this is actually like. Of course, the most important way to understand what this is, is just to experience it. And I hope you've had a chance to do that before coming to this point. But if

you'd like to revisit it, maybe one thing I'll point out that we can consider, perhaps you already noticed this as you watched and read, the version that we see being performed in the video is not based exactly on the that we have to be read right. As I pointed out earlier, there's countless different variations across school lineage performer all of this.

So it's not like the text that you read is like a transcription of everything that you heard in the play. Of course, even if it were, dealing with different translators, there's like another layer of variation there as well. But we can, it might be interesting to sort of compare the versus the video performance that we have. But it's inevitable that there's gonna be both major and subtle differences there. What we can do, I think, is challenging to sort of compare them side by side, but we can sort of appreciate elements of the video performance itself, especially and if you have the opportunity to rewatch it with these things. In mind, I encourage you to really take note of how the singer distinguishes between when she's speaking in the role of a and when she's narrating, and also not to overlook the role of the and to think about when he speaks.

Right? When he sort of makes these vocal interjections at very sort of deliberate and appropriate moments throughout the performance. Another thing to think about is we can read the subtitles. If we understand Korean, we can listen to the dialogue and think about the story that's being told here, but we should also, like, use our eyes and use other parts of our ears as well. Right? Think about what elements of this. performance are also contributing to the emotion that the characters are and the story that's being told. So I'm talking about things like gesture: how does the singer use the fan, the only sort of prop that she has access to? How does she kind of use it and use her hands and use facial expression, motion, and other kinds of elements of the performance?

None of this is accidental, right? All of this is a very deliberate part of what the performer is doing. We might think about when she's kind of sitting or kneeling down versus when she's standing up. Is she moving across the stage? Is she sort of looking in a certain direction? We might think. that some of these might have a kind of, you know, like encoded or symbolic meaning that's hard to interpret if we're not really experienced audience members. But in my opinion, you know, as someone who is not an expert by any means in this form, it's still really possible to get a much richer sense of the emotions and kind of atmosphere of the story if we're really paying attention to the movement and gesture and expressions of the performer, not just looking at the words.

Right? This is a kind of important component of the performance. And we should note, right, that even though, okay, the script and the performance, of course, are very different These kinds of stage directions are not part of that written form, right? So they might be even more opportunity for like unique embellishment and interpretation on behalf of the performer. But of course some of these would be part of what's transmitted directly to that student from their teacher, right? So this is a level of differentiation that I'm afraid we won't be able to spend enough time on to really be able to distinguish. But I think we can at least consider the possibility or rather consider all of the different variables that are going to be influencing what this performance looks like, right, even if We can't identify exactly what they are.

We should keep in mind that some of these are going to be kind of inherited traditions from the

history of that school. Others may have been taught directly from this performer's immediate teacher, sort of transmitted from their own personal style to their student. Others might be kind of innovations or flourishes based on the individual style of that performer. And others might be just sort of, you know, spur of the moment choices made in the context of this video, this single video of the performance. So even beyond thinking about what the performers are doing, we can also think about everything else that's part of the kind of staging, the sort of visual aspect of this performance, from the artwork we see in the background, to the lighting, to the kind of color scheme that's used, to the clothing that the performers are.

I'm saying all of this, you know, I think in some ways this kind of contributes to what we're appreciating as an example of like a traditional performance. You know, this is from one of the five kind of canonical stories. This is being presented in the context of like cultural education. This is certainly something that, in some ways, is going to capture some very traditional elements. And yet we might also think about, even, you know, without the privilege of being able to compare it to other performances. We might also note the sort of, like, abstract or kind of contemporary style of the artwork in the background: the really bright, colorful lighting; the sort of choices that were made in order to make this appealing, first and foremost, as like a video that we can encounter online, rather than, you know, someone who happens to bring a video camera into a theater to record what was meant to be appreciated as a live performance.

So, to say a bit more about what I'm talking about, I'd like to compare just a from the video that we saw with some other stagings of the same story. So we can see certainly the performers are wearing this kind of traditional style clothing. We have kind of limited set dressing in the form of a potted plant in the background and two pieces of art which, you know, for watching the video we may not have the opportunity to really scrutinize them. But now that we have the chance to see it up close, we can see that this is a very contemporary backdrop, even though we have this kind of traditional-like folding screen form that's often present in Pansori performances. We can see some elements of the artwork, right? This kind of handbag here.

I think this is probably a turntable in the top of the screen and so on, right? So they're kind of blending in some very 21st century, right? Some very contemporary elements into the background of this performance. To sort of illustrate this by way of contrast, we could also look at another staging of, I think in fact the same scene. If you'd like to watch this, I'll put a link to this video in the, you know, as always, kind of additional reading section of the PowerPoint slides that you'll find at the end. This is a performance of the same scene, probably, you know, a different version of it from a different tradition performed as by members of the kind of like national troupe for the performance of traditional music in Korea.

So this was it's a kind of filmed version of a theatrical performance. I think in this case, this is, you know, thinking back, I think it was produced in 2020. So this is one of these things that was produced as a of cultural enrichment activity for people who were stuck in their homes in the early days of COVID-19. So there's a very contemporary element behind the context of this performance, but it's one that I think nevertheless has a bit fewer of those kind of pop culture, like 21st-century embellishments that we see in the staging of the video. that we watched a longer portion. And

then finally, just for another sort of interpretation, again I would also say this is done in a very traditional kind of standard style.

This is a performance of a different, obviously different staging of the play. I believe also from a different scene, not that it matters, just looking at a screenshot, but it's performed by a kind of elder statesman, Wang Giseok, a sort of famous pansori performer in Korea. This is from a televised version of performance of a different scene of the story of Simcheong. And the only thing I want to point out to here is that we might imagine this representing the kind of a state of the art in terms of traditional performance style performed by the sort of revered member of the community. But there's an almost sort of postmodern kind of interpretation of the backdrop here.

We can see these kind of shadowy silhouettes of bamboo leaves as a kind of contemporary interpretation of what we might expect to see as the backdrop in the performance. So again, links to all of these videos will be in the additional reading section of the PowerPoint slide that you can download. Unfortunately, this final one doesn't have English language subtitles. The other two both do. So let's try to bring this all to a conclusion to think about studying and evolving, and sort of transforming tradition. I'm using the word evolving here; I sometimes wince when I say it. By saying evolving, I hope this goes without saying, but I don't mean to imply that this is constantly getting better.

I don't mean evolution in the sense of survival of the fittest; I just mean evolution in the sense of constantly changing what we could perhaps refer to as a tradition. So, we can say that some basic details of Pansori performance are consistent regardless when we're thinking about, at least in terms of the well-documented history of this performance. style we need to have a definition right. So we could say that Pansori performance involves two performers: the singer and the drummer. It involves limited props, limited backdrops, and so on, but with a lot of flexibility there. We know that full performances can be quite long, but they're often performed in scenes or other excerpts, and this has been true throughout the history of the form, more or less.

Again, thinking of the entire history of Pansori as one thing, I would say this much we can say has been consistent throughout more or. But beyond those shared details, there are lots of different variables, variations according. to school teacher and individual style. We might also think about, though, the context and purpose of a performance, right? So, the same performer that we saw in the video, she's both a performer and a scholar of Pansori history and performance. When she's making a presentation for the sake of educating, you know, presumably this really broad audience, including those who happen to find the sort of, you know, Korean Cultural Center of Los Angeles YouTube page, as well as people within Korea, people all over the world, different things might be done to make the sort of performance more appropriate or more educational or more entertaining.

depending on the audience they intend to reach. But this also kind of raises the question of like bigger changes over longer periods of time, right? We can think about this kind of variation and embellishment in the of individual performers, but we might also think about, you know, how can we put this into context over longer periods of time? And this is going to lead us into the next units of this module. In the next unit, we'll be talking about the early history, including the kind of

scholarly debate or discussion over where Pansori actually comes from, through roughly the sort of what's known as the kind of peak, or like golden. era of Pansori performance in around the 19th and early 20th century and then kind of concluding with some discussion of like modernization in those kind of mid 20th century contexts.

And then in the final unit, we'll be talking about Pansori in contemporary times, which of course the videos that we've looked at today are also part of. Right? These aren't video footages of performances from the 19th century; they are also part of Pansori today. But in the final unit of the module, we'll sort of put these into conversation with some more kind of radically creative departures, some of which, by the way, are also performed by the same people that we see in today's videos. So that's a way to kind of bring things to a conclusion for today. I'd like to now move on to a sort of brief discussion of the assignment and quiz details for this unit. So this is, as always, available in part of the assignment text on the Canvas page. But what I'd like us to do for this assignment is just to think of this question of adapting folklore or adapting kind of popular stories into different media. So in this unit, I've used a single example: these kinds of adaptations and interpretations of this folktale of Simcheong. Within the context of Pansori, we also see a lot of variety

adapted. into other media as well. Other forms of traditional theatre that might involve more than two people on stage, for example, because this is a really popular piece of folklore. There's also sort of picture books, maybe longer kind of novelistic adaptations, feature films, television programs, anything you can imagine, right, could potentially be adapted into those forms. So I've kind of started to talk about how even within the context of pansori performance, there's like a lot of possibility for variation. Well, what would happen if we were to say, well, what I want to do now is make a two-hour movie in a kind of contemporary let's say contemporary animated film that's adapted from the same story. Right? So what I'd like us to do this writing assignment is just to think of another example of a folktale or popular story.

You can define this however you see fit for this assignment. But what I'd like us to think about is something that's been adapted into at least two or three different media. So, I'm not talking about like a film and a remake of the film, but some kind of older story that emerges from, you know, fairy tales or folklores that you can think of a specific example of an adaptation into, let's say, a feature-length film and a children's picture book or. something If you're familiar with those two examples, great. You might choose, you know, different media examples depending on what you're thinking of. But what I'd like you to do is sort of think about this in the context of adaptation, right?

Think about how the sort of technical limitations of the media, that it's audience expectations, you know, who is being targeted as the main audience for this particular adaptation. Are there any kind of formal or genre conventions that also influence the way it's being told? And just try to consider a little bit about how these might impact the form that that adaptation takes. And then If possible, we can say, you know, on top of all of these sort of bigger, like media-based or genre-based conventions, there's also, of course, a great degree of like individual artistic or creative choice that goes into an adaptation as well. So this is again potentially something that could form the basis of a very long kind of analytical paper.

What I'd like us to do, as usual for these writing assignments, is just to do a kind of free writing, like brainstorming exercise, thinking about some of these details in relation to an example of your choice. And I think the best way to sort of process some of what we've today is to try to make some direct reference or comparisons to elements of adaptations of the story of Xin Chong that I've brought up in today's lecture. And so, I think that will really be the best way to help you connect whatever example you've chosen back to the kind of core details from today's class. And finally, as usual, there's also going to be a quiz. I just want to let you know if I'm going to include kind of technical or foreign terms, even if they've already appeared in this lecture, I will provide you with definitions.

So, your preparation doesn't need to like memorizing, for example, this word for narration that appears in the marginal note. in the script. If I use a foreign term, I will try to define it for you. There, I will address plot, from, you know, general plot details from the story of Xin Chong, as well as more specific details contained within the assigned excerpts of the text, as well as some issues in the study of performance and theatre. So, the kind of conceptual things I've talked about over the course of the lecture today. And, as usual, this will be just a short five questions, and you'll have 10 minutes to complete it. All right, so that's all you need to take care of for the rest of this unit. And I'll see you back for the lecture in unit.